

STAGE EIGHT • SOFT SKILLS

# FIRSTS

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## COMPLETION CRITERIA

*What counts as done, and how it triggers the Stage Eight credential*

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

BY AYOMIDE AYENI

# FIRSTS • Completion Criteria & Credential Trigger

*Stage Eight • Soft Skills*

## PURPOSE

This document defines exactly what “complete” means for Stage Eight, at both the individual FIRST level and the full-stage level, and how completion connects to the program's credentialing system. Because so much of this stage's real learning happens through live, interpersonal practice rather than solo written work, this stage's completion standard leans more heavily on facilitator observation than most.

## Per-FIRST Standard

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### STANDARD

*A FIRST counts as complete when the corresponding Templates worksheet has a genuine, specific answer in every required field, and for FIRSTS involving a real interpersonal action (giving feedback, mediating a conflict, having a networking conversation), when that action has genuinely been practiced with a real person, not just described hypothetically.*

## Stage-Level Completion Checklist

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- All 50 Templates worksheets completed with genuine, specific answers (see per-FIRST standard above).
- Attendance or async completion confirmed for all 6 sessions.
- Genuine participation in at least the majority of this stage's paired and small-group exercises, not just the individual reflection worksheets — confirmed through facilitator observation during live sessions.
- A specific, real soft skill growth example named at the Session 6 close, not a generic statement.

## Facilitator Sign-Off

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Because so much of this stage happens live and interpersonally, facilitator sign-off should rely more heavily on direct observation during sessions than in stages built around solo worksheet completion. A participant who completed every worksheet but was consistently disengaged during paired and group exercises has not genuinely completed this stage's actual learning, even if their paperwork is complete.

## Credential Trigger

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### HOW THE BADGE WORKS

*Upon facilitator sign-off, the participant's record is marked "Stage Eight Complete" in the program tracker, which triggers the Stage Eight digital badge. As with every stage, badges accumulate visibly; the full-program certificate is issued only once all 16 stages are marked complete.*